Alfonso Graña

Developer experience & platform engineering leader

Eindhoven, Netherlands

Application: Engineering Manager, Engineering Experience | Vinted

Profile

Hands-on engineering leader with 20 years of experience in production systems, cloud infrastructure and developer platforms. At Brenntag, I manage two employees and define developer-platform direction for 25+ engineering teams and 350+ engineers. I turn delivery friction into roadmap priorities, reusable CI/CD capabilities and practical engineering standards.

My strongest fit is the Developer Portal team: treating internal engineers as customers, making shared capabilities easier to adopt, and connecting platform strategy with reliable software delivery. I combine people management and distributed-team mentoring with hands-on experience in cloud infrastructure, SRE and governed AI-assisted development.

Core capabilities

Platform strategy and roadmaps • Internal developer products • People management and mentoring • Stakeholder alignment • Golden paths and reusable delivery patterns • CI/CD and release engineering • Security in the SDLC • AI-assisted development • SLOs and production readiness • Incident response and observability

Experience

Brenntag | Amsterdam

DevEx Tech Lead | June 2025 - Present

- Manage two employees and define technical direction for a developer platform serving 25+ teams and 350+ engineers.
- Own platform direction across CI/CD, software artifact management and agile collaboration tooling, covering the SDLC from ideation to production deployment.
- Partner with development, data and security teams to identify friction and translate it into platform roadmap priorities.
- Guide consolidation and governance of developer and security tooling to improve adoption and reduce cognitive load for engineering teams.
- Evaluate and support adoption of AI-assisted development tools, balancing developer productivity with security and responsible use.
- Work with vendors to improve tooling adoption and the value of technology investments.

Developer Experience Engineer | January 2024 - May 2025

- Developed reusable GitLab CI/CD components used by 200+ projects, standardising cloud configuration and artifact management to reduce pipeline setup effort.
- Maintained and improved shared developer tooling for 25+ engineering teams across GitLab, JFrog Artifactory, Snyk and Atlassian workflows.
- Helped teams adopt consistent delivery patterns across the enterprise SDLC toolchain.

Shell Recharge Solutions | Amsterdam

Senior Site Reliability Engineer | January 2023 - December 2023

- Defined SLIs, SLOs and error budgets with product teams for a global AWS/EKS platform supporting 100K+ active EV charge points.
- Reviewed production-readiness practices across product teams; led cloud incident escalations and captured lessons through postmortems.
- Drove AWS right-sizing with engineering teams, saving approximately $1M annually.
- Operated the central Aurora PostgreSQL cluster and automated MongoDB Atlas organisation setup and configuration.

WCC | Utrecht

Senior Site Reliability Engineer | October 2021 - January 2023

- Established the SRE function as the first SRE hire, defining reliability practices, processes and tooling across a distributed engineering organisation.
- Built CI/CD and infrastructure-as-code pipelines that accelerated release cadence from monthly to daily.
- Introduced APM and distributed tracing so product teams could investigate production behaviour with actionable evidence.
- Mentored engineering teams in the Netherlands and Malaysia in automation, CI/CD and reliability; contributed to the architecture review board and company-wide standards.

ASML, via Itility | Eindhoven

DevOps Engineer / Consultant | July 2019 - September 2021

- Delivered CI/CD pipelines for a telemetry container platform deployed in customer semiconductor fabs, supporting hundreds of deployment targets.
- Managed Mesosphere DC/OS deployments for 40+ containerised applications; automated cluster management and application deployments with Ansible.
- Led Azure and Azure DevOps adoption for automated deployment of development and test environments.
- Partnered with the Cloud Center of Excellence on secure, cost-aware cloud adoption.

Liveclicker | Montevideo, Uruguay

Senior Cloud Engineer | November 2016 - June 2019

- Built and operated AWS capabilities for real-time email and video commerce products handling high-volume marketing campaigns.
- Migrated EC2 Classic workloads to VPC and standalone MySQL databases to Aurora; re-architected a web-scraping component using JavaScript, S3, API Gateway and Lambda.
- Introduced Ansible deployments and ChatOps for QA-driven releases, reducing release cycles from days to hours; built a Kinesis analytics ingestion pipeline.

Earlier career | 2004 - 2016

Head of IT Infrastructure, inConcert (2013 - 2016) • Senior Linux Sysadmin, HG via NetLabs (2012 - 2013) • Infrastructure Specialist, Abitab (2011 - 2012) • IT Manager / System Administrator, Telecom Networks (2008 - 2011) • Systems / Network Administrator, Finning South America (2004 - 2008).

Experience includes team leadership, SaaS reliability, data-centre operations, Linux and network infrastructure, and international customer migrations.

AI-assisted engineering practice

Professional experience evaluating and governing coding assistants, including Cursor and Claude Code. Personal projects include hands-on use of coding agents, MCP integrations and persistent-memory agent workflows with Hermes and Honcho, with human review and verification of generated changes.

Technical foundation

Cloud and automation: AWS, Azure, Kubernetes/EKS, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible.
Delivery and reliability: GitLab CI/CD, GitOps, JFrog Artifactory, Snyk, Atlassian, APM, distributed tracing, SLOs, incident management.
Programming: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript.

Certifications and education

AWS Solutions Architect Professional (2024) • AWS DevOps Engineer Professional (2022) • Azure Developer Associate (2021) • Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate (2023) • MLOps Specialization, Coursera (2021).

Electrónica Informática studies, ORT Uruguay (2008 - 2011) • Backend Developer, Node.js, Hack Academy (2018) • Linux Operating Systems and Advanced Linux Server Administration, ORT Uruguay (2004 - 2005).

Languages

English: full professional proficiency • Spanish: native/bilingual • Dutch: basic A2